

Superforecasting: The Art and Science of Prediction

Authors: Philip E. Tetlock, Dan Gardner

Publication context: 2015

Corpus priority: Phase 1

Document type: Synthesized RAG source dossier built from publicly available online material

Purpose In This RAG Corpus

- One of the strongest practical books on probabilistic reasoning and improving forecast quality.
- Highly relevant for strategic decisions, uncertainty communication, AI evaluation, and governance.
- Balances the bias literature by focusing on what better judgment looks like in practice.

Key Concepts And Retrieval Tags

- probabilistic_thinking
- calibration
- updating
- forecast_decomposition
- humility
- aggregation

Core Learnings

- Most experts are poor forecasters, but some individuals consistently outperform by using disciplined habits rather than special intuition.
- Good forecasting is iterative: break problems down, estimate in probabilities, update often, and revise when new evidence appears.
- Strong forecasters combine open-mindedness with skepticism, humility, and comfort with uncertainty.
- Forecast accuracy improves when judgments are calibrated and numerically explicit rather than vague and categorical.
- The book helps shift decisions from confident storytelling toward evidence-weighted probabilistic reasoning.

Directions, Observations, And Implications

- Use the book for strategic planning, risk registers, policy evaluation, and scenario analysis.
- Bring its ideas into the copilot when users need confidence ranges, updating discipline, or uncertainty-aware recommendations.
- Use it to mitigate overconfidence and narrative certainty in leadership or AI-assisted planning.

How This Can Be Applied In Decision Making

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How This Strengthens A Bias-Aware RAG System

- Very useful for evaluation prompts, confidence communication, and structured uncertainty handling.
- Strengthens retrieval for scenarios involving forecasting, strategic bets, and model-evaluation tradeoffs.
- Provides a practical counterweight to purely diagnostic bias content.

Limitations And Cautions

- This dossier is based on public summaries and publisher descriptions rather than the full text.
- It should be supplemented later with more primary material from Tetlock's forecasting research.

Source Notes

- Apple Books publisher description (publisher_description):
<https://books.apple.com/us/book/superforecasting/id989620031>
- Wikipedia overview of the Good Judgment Project (project_overview):
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Good_Judgment_Project
- Good Judgment context via public forecasting discussion (secondary_summary): <https://www.theguardian.com/global-development-professionals-network/2017/mar/06/forewarned-is-forearmed-learning-how-to-predict-the-future>

RAG Ingestion Note

This document is intentionally written as a concise, retrieval-friendly synthesis rather than as a book review. It is designed to help the system retrieve named biases and decision failures, practical mitigation methods, organizational and AI-governance implications, and scenario-to-concept mappings for user prompts.